

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with over a year of paralegal and legal adviser experience across litigation, disputes and client advisory work. Practical background in supporting fee earners: preparing hearing bundles and court materials, drafting procedural documents and correspondence, reviewing and organising evidence, managing case files and tracking deadlines. Experienced in direct client communication across housing, employment, family, debt and welfare benefits matters. Looking to apply that experience in a paralegal role supporting fee earners at a central London firm.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules in Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; carried partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from first client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, drafts correspondence, prepares application documents and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients across housing, employment, family, debt and welfare benefits matters; translates complex procedural rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported fee earners on a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the memorial
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline, helping ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files, monitored procedural deadlines and liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated with an external translator on Romanian-language materials
- Received partner and associate feedback that performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Handled court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons; maintained matter records via iManage
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to delivery of a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders and prepared an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis and evidence review; electronic bundling and court filing portals; iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence drafting

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters, confidential document management